Via Nova Rules v56

2-4 players / 30-40 mn / 10yo+ Stefan Alexander

Game Overview

Build a city worthy of Rome. Match buildings to fuel your expansion, train and upgrade soldiers and engineers, and compete for military victories and inventions. Timing is everything: claim your rewards before rivals overtake you, or commit more people to secure first choice.

Your victories give you valuable rebuild tiles which let you replace existing buildings, and have scrolls and banners on them which create valuable scoring opportunities. Earn the most victory points to win.

Components



48 dominos, with quarries (yellow), markets (orange), libraries (green), barracks (red), temples (blue), and arches (purple)



12 start tiles (with dotted borders)



Backs of start tiles



20 arch (purple) tiles



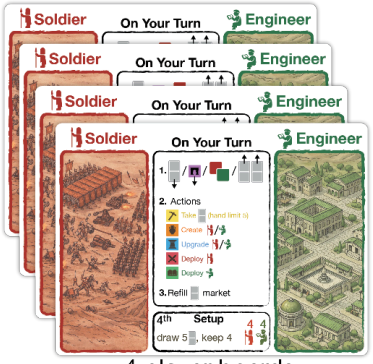
26 battle rebuild tiles



22 invention rebuild tiles



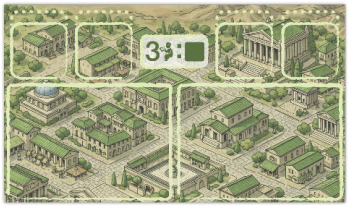
64 meeples: 16 in each of four colours (“1” on one side, “2” on the other side)



4 player boards



Battle board



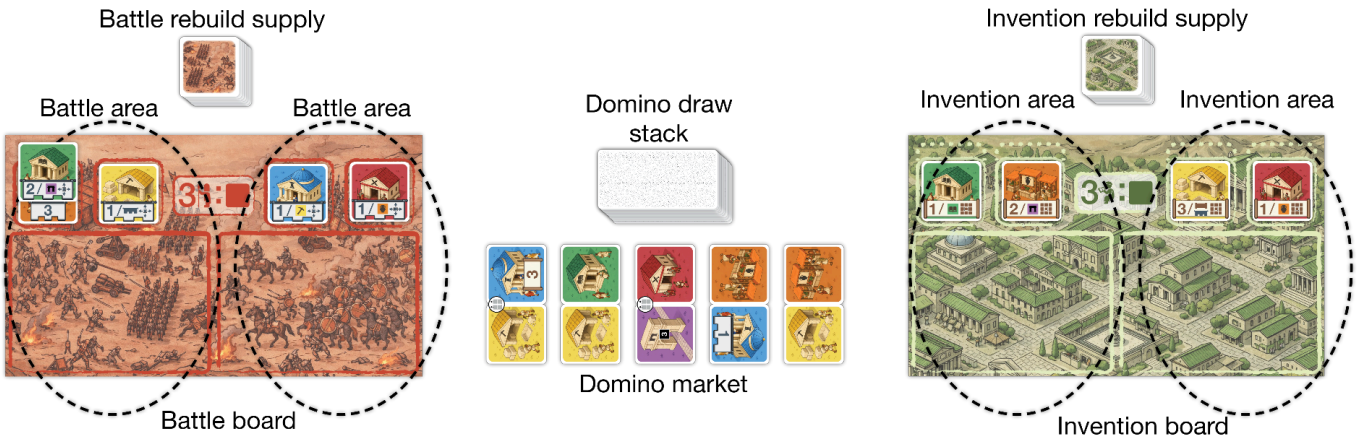
Invention board

Setup

Set up components in the middle of the table.

- Put the Battle board and Invention board in the middle of the table.
- Shuffle the dominos, Battle rebuild tiles and Invention rebuild tiles separately. Place each in a face-down supply.
- Randomly remove tiles according to the player count:
    - **2 players: Remove 17 dominos, 11 Battle rebuild tiles, and 9 Invention rebuild tiles**
    - **3 players: Remove 8 dominos, 5 Battle rebuild tiles, and 4 Invention rebuild tiles**
    - **4 players: Use all dominos and rebuild tiles**
- Turn 5 dominos face-up from the **domino draw stack** to form the **domino market**
- Reveal two rebuild tiles in each area. If it has a "+", draw a second tile from that supply and overlap it, keeping both scoring panels visible. Ignore any "+" on the second tile - do not stack a third tile.

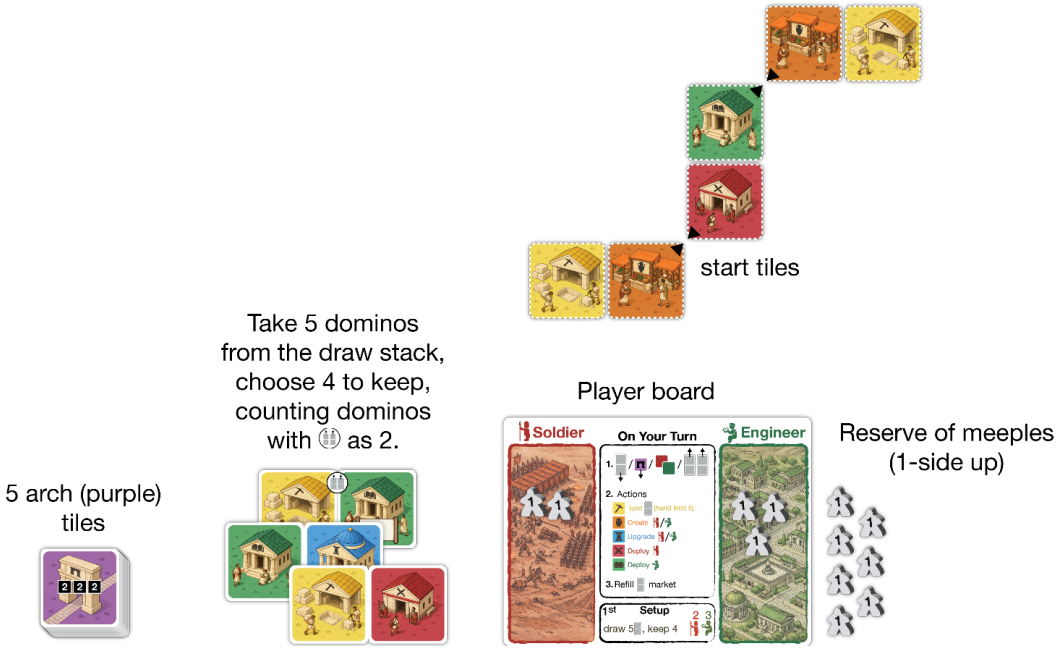
The setup is shown below.



Choose a start player. Each player:

- Takes the player board matching their turn order: “1st” for the start player, then “2nd”, and so on clockwise. These labels are in the Setup section at the bottom of each board.
- Takes all 16 population meeples of one colour and places them in their **reserve**, beside their player board, “1” side up.
- Places 5 purple Arch tiles face-up beside their player board.
- Takes one starting tile each marked “A”, “B” and “C” on the back, arranging them as shown below, with the black arrows pointing towards each other.
- Draws 5 dominos and keeps a total value of exactly 4, counting unmarked dominos as 1 and each domino with the double-domino icon () as 2. Return the others to the bottom of the stack. For example, you could keep one domino with the double-domino icon and two unmarked dominos.
- Puts meeples from their reserve in their Soldier and Engineer areas as shown in their player board’s Setup section.
- Puts 1 meeple from their reserve in each of the four Battle and Invention areas, “1” side up.

Each player’s play area is as shown below.



Gameplay

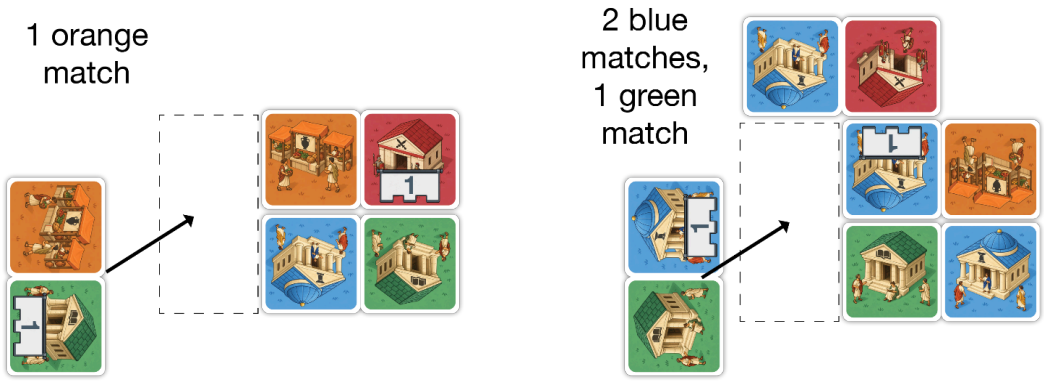
On your turn, choose one option:

1. Place a domino
2. Place a single Arch
3. Resolve areas
4. Take dominos

Take any resulting actions, then refill the domino market at the end of your turn.

1. Place a domino (and take actions)

Place a domino from your hand in any orientation, with at least one edge touching an existing tile. Matching colours with existing tiles is optional - but if you do match, gain one action **for each matching edge** of your new tile. Take these actions in any order, using the building actions shown on your player board.



Quarry (yellow): **Take a domino**. Some dominos are marked with a double-domino icon. One action takes an unmarked market domino or the top domino from the stack. Taking a market domino marked with uses two actions. Your hand limit is 5 dominos; each counts as one, marked or not. At the limit, you cannot take more.

Market (orange): **Create a Soldier or Engineer.** Move one meeple from your reserve to either the Soldier or Engineer area on your player board, "1" side up.

Temple (blue): **Upgrade a Soldier or Engineer** on your player board to the "2" side.

Barracks (red): **Deploy** a soldier. Move one soldier from your player board to any Battle area, keeping its current side up.

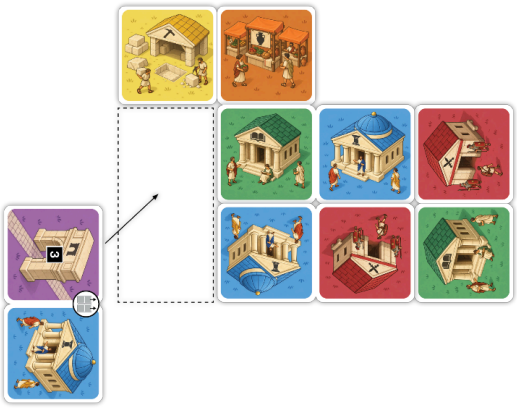
Library (green): **Deploy** an engineer. Move one engineer from your player board to any Invention area, keeping its current side up.

Actions are optional and cannot be saved for later turns.

Some dominos have an Arch marked "3", which grants three actions from one adjacent building of your choice. You may choose the other building on the same domino. Take any matching actions from the domino's other building before or after these three actions. Arches have no action themselves, so matching or activating an existing Arch does nothing.

The player places the domino. The Arch could grant 3 actions from the yellow building, green building, or the blue building from the domino that was just placed.

The matching action from the blue building can be taken before or after the 3 Arch actions.



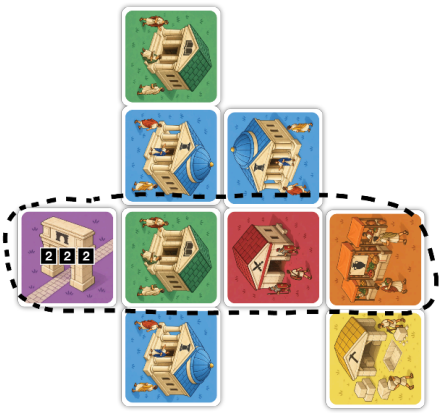
Choose Arch positions carefully. Other buildings can be covered by rebuild tiles later in the game, but Arches are permanent and must remain uncovered.

2. Place a single Arch (and take actions)

Place a single Arch from your supply next to a building in your city. Its “2 2 2” activates the next three spaces in a straight line up, down, left or right. Take two actions from each building in order, starting with the space next to the Arch.

The player places the Arch, and chooses to activate the 3 tiles to the right. This lets the player take actions **in this order**:

1. Deploy 2 engineers, to the same or different Invention areas.
2. Deploy 2 soldiers, to the same or different Battle areas.
3. Add 2 population to their player board (either soldiers, engineers, or 1 of each).



Remember to choose Arch positions carefully, since they cannot be covered by a rebuild tile, so will stay there for the rest of the game.

If one of the three spaces is an Arch or empty space, it gives no actions but still counts as one of the three spaces.

3. Resolve areas (and take rebuild tiles)

You may resolve one or more areas where you have at least 3 population, counting upgraded meeples as 2. You may resolve areas in any order, and you may leave eligible areas unresolved.

1. Only players with at least 3 population in the area can take rebuild tiles. Of these players, the player with the most population chooses a rebuild tile, then the player with the second-most takes the other. Break ties in favour of the active player, then clockwise around the table.

   These players must take their tiles. Whenever a chosen tile has another stacked on it, take both. Other players receive nothing. If only one player has at least 3 population, the unchosen tile or stack stays in place.

2. All players return their meeples from the resolved area. Players who received a tile return theirs to their reserve, “1” side up. All others return theirs to the matching Soldier or Engineer area on their player board, “2” side up.
3. After awarding rebuild tiles for an area, immediately refill the vacated spaces, stacking tiles with a “+”. Remember two tiles can be stacked, but do not stack a third.
4. After resolving all chosen areas, place every awarded rebuild tile over one building in your city. You may cover earlier rebuild tiles. **You must never cover a purple Arch, whether it is part of a domino or a single tile.**

   Place your rebuild tiles separately, in any order. Only the top tile’s building, colour and scoring symbol count. Rebuilding grants no actions, but the new building can generate matching actions on later turns.

4. Take dominos

Take two “Take a domino” actions (see Quarry). Market dominos with the  symbol cost two actions. The hand limit of 5 dominos still applies.

End of turn

Refill the domino market to 5 tiles, then play passes to your left.

End of game and scoring

When one of the supplies runs out (dominos, Battle rebuilds or Invention rebuilds), finish the current turn. Each player then takes one final turn, ending with the player who emptied the supply. If there aren't enough rebuild tiles to refill an area, leave the remaining spaces empty.

After the last turn, resolve all Battle and Invention areas. Award tiles and return meeples as usual; only players with at least 3 population qualify for tiles. Break ties clockwise from the player to the left of whoever took the last turn. Place all awarded rebuild tiles before scoring.

Score each visible scroll and banner as shown below. A plain number is a fixed score; otherwise, multiply the number by the matching items in its scoring area. For scrolls, use the 3×3 area centred on their tile. For banners, use their tile's entire row and column. Both include their own tile; gaps do not interrupt banner scoring.

For each scroll or banner, count each matching item only once. The same items may count again when scoring other scrolls or banners. Add all your scores. The player with the most points wins. Among tied players, whoever has the most population on their player board wins (upgraded meeples count as 2). If still tied, they share the victory.

Scrolls
(on Invention rebuild tiles and some dominos)



3 points

The scrolls below score matching items in a 3x3 area around the scroll, including the tile bearing this scroll.



Quarries (yellow)



Markets (orange)



Temples (blue)



Libraries (green)



Barracks (red)



Arches (purple)



Scrolls



Pairs of scrolls and banners
(For example, 2 scrolls and 3 banners in the scoring area would make 2 pairs, worth 6 points. The 2 scrolls may include this scroll itself.)

Banners
(on Battle rebuild tiles and some dominos)



1 point



3 points

The banners below score matching items in their row and column. It includes the tile bearing this banner, but count that only once. Gaps do not interrupt scoring.



Quarries (yellow)



Markets (orange)



Temples (blue)



Libraries (green)



Barracks (red)



Arches (purple)



Banners



Pairs of scrolls and banners
(For example, 2 scrolls and 3 banners in the scoring area would make 2 pairs, worth 6 points. The 3 banners may include this banner itself.)